

# THE ZERO PARADOX

## ZP-M: Kleene-Ordinal Bridge

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Synthesis bridge. All theorems §I–§IV proved sorry-free in Lean 4. Closes the hfp free hypothesis (ZP-L) and the snapEmbed type bridge. Axiom footprint: [propext, Classical.choice, Quot.sound] throughout.

ZP-M bridges the two prior layers — ZP-K (computational grounding via Kleene's second recursion theorem) and ZP-L (ordinal snap threshold at  $\epsilon_0$ ) — with two formal results. First, the free hypothesis hfp in snap\_exactly\_at\_epsilon\_zero (ZP-L §VI) is proved to follow from a minimal alignment hypothesis plus monotonicity: hfp is not an independent condition. Second, the canonical type bridge snapEmbed : MachinePhase  $\rightarrow$   $\mathbb{Z}_2$  formalizes the structural triangle connecting the pre-snap state  $c_0$  (read as the Kleene quine, a KleeneStructure requirement in ZP-K, not a theorem), the ordinal snap at  $\epsilon_0$  (ZP-L), and the 2-adic limit 0 (ZP-B).

The closing result (§IV) records that both the Kleene recursion theorem and the ordinal fixed-point  $\epsilon_0 = \omega^{\epsilon_0}$  are instances of the same diagonalization pattern: a self-referential operation produces a forced fixed point. The two domains — computability theory (codes and Gödel numbers) and ordinal theory ( $\omega$ -tower iteration) — use no shared mathematical machinery, but the structural schema is identical. Remark R-M.1 tracks what this means for DA-1 Path 2 and the boundary of the diagonalization frame.

### Section I: The snapEmbed Morphism

snapEmbed is the canonical type bridge from ZP-E's machine-phase state space to ZP-B's 2-adic integers. The pre-snap state  $c_0$  maps to 1 (a 2-adic unit); the snap state  $c_1$  maps to 0 (the 2-adic limit of the tower encodings). Under multiplication on  $\mathbb{Z}_2$ , 0 is absorbing — mirroring exactly the join structure on MachinePhase, where  $c_1$  is the absorbing element.

Within the ZP framework,  $0 \in \mathbb{Z}_2$  plays the role of  $\perp$  — it is the 2-adic valuation limit and the fixed point of multiplication by 2. snapEmbed makes this modelling commitment concrete:  $c_1$  maps to 0 because  $c_1$  IS the object at infinite 2-adic depth. This is a modelling commitment, not a ring-theoretic theorem.

#### Definition: snapEmbed (Incompleteness.lean §I)

snapEmbed : MachinePhase  $\rightarrow$   $\mathbb{Z}_2$

snapEmbed  $c_0 = 1$  (pre-snap: 2-adic unit)

snapEmbed  $c_1 = 0$  (snap state: 2-adic zero = 2-adic limit of tower)

The morphism property: join on MachinePhase ( $c_1$  is absorbing under join) corresponds to multiplication on  $\mathbb{Z}_2$  (0 is absorbing under  $\times$ ). Both structures share the absorbing-element pattern — the bridge is structural, not incidental.

### Theorem: snapEmbed\_injective (Incompleteness.lean §I)

Function.Injective snapEmbed

$c_0$  and  $c_1$  map to distinct 2-adic integers ( $1 \neq 0$  in  $\mathbb{Z}_2$ ).

Proof: case split on MachinePhase; simp\_all closes each case.

Lean purity: [propext, Classical.choice, Quot.sound]. ✓

### Theorem: snapEmbed\_mul\_morphism (Incompleteness.lean §I)

$\forall a\ b : \text{MachinePhase}, \text{snapEmbed} (\text{join } a\ b) = \text{snapEmbed } a \times \text{snapEmbed } b$

snapEmbed sends the join operation to multiplication.

Under this map, the absorbing-element structure is preserved:

$\text{join } c_1\ x = c_1$  for all  $x \leftrightarrow 0 \times y = 0$  for all  $y \in \mathbb{Z}_2$ .

Proof: case split; simp [snapEmbed].

Lean purity: [propext, Classical.choice, Quot.sound]. ✓

### Lemma: snapEmbed\_c0\_val (Incompleteness.lean §I)

$(\text{snapEmbed } c_0).\text{valuation} = 0$

$c_0$  maps to a 2-adic unit: valuation 0, norm 1.

Proof: simp via PadicInt.valuation\_one.

Lean purity: [propext, Classical.choice, Quot.sound]. ✓

### Lemma: snapEmbed\_c1\_dvd (Incompleteness.lean §I)

$\forall n : \mathbb{N}, (2 : \mathbb{Z}_2)^n \mid \text{snapEmbed } c_1$

$c_1$  maps to 0, which is divisible by all powers of 2.

$0 \in \mathbb{Z}_2$  is divisible by  $2^n$  for every  $n$  — infinite 2-adic depth.

This is the formal signature of  $\perp = \{\perp\}$ : infinite 2-adic valuation.

Proof: simp [snapEmbed\_c1].

Lean purity: [propext, Classical.choice, Quot.sound]. ✓

### Remark: snapEmbed and the bottom role

snapEmbed establishes the morphism property ( $\text{join} \mapsto \times$ ) and the absorbing-element correspondence. Relative to the ordinals' floor, the bottom-role occupant 0 and the  $\varepsilon_0$  occupant differ (epsilon0\_ne\_bot); against the 2-adic 0 an identity with  $\varepsilon_0$  is not a well-formed statement (it fails to elaborate, Ordinal vs  $\mathbb{Z}_2$ ), and the link runs through maps: snapEmbed sends  $c_1$  to 0, the  $\mathbb{Z}_2$  chart's bottom-role occupant. The canonical threshold map  $\text{Ordinal} \rightarrow \text{MachinePhase}$  is order-non-decreasing in ZP-A's join order (snap\_map\_mono), and no map  $\text{Ordinal} \rightarrow \text{MachinePhase}$  is compatible with the  $\text{CNF} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}_2$  map along the tower: for every  $g : \text{MachinePhase} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}_2$  the square fails, because MachinePhase has two values and stages 1, 2, 3 have three distinct 2-adic valuations (the example after c1\_epsilon\_zero\_identification in ZeroParadox/Ordinal/Gentzen.lean); through snapEmbed it fails at every stage  $n \geq 1$ , because snapEmbed takes only the values 1 and 0, and stage  $n \geq 1$  maps to  $2^n$ , which is neither (ZeroParadox/Ordinal/Incompleteness.lean § II).

What the bridge achieves:  $c_1$  (the snap state assigned at  $\varepsilon_0$ ) maps to 0 (the 2-adic limit) under snapEmbed. The triangle is formally exhibited. Whether Classical.choice is forced by the ZP metric collapse is a separate open question (ZeroParadox/Ordinal/SyntacticCollapse.lean).

## Section II: Closing the hfp Gap

snap\_exactly\_at\_epsilon\_zero (ZP-L §VI) carries a free hypothesis hfp asserting that for any map  $\phi : \text{Ordinal} \rightarrow \text{MachinePhase}$ , every fixed point of  $\omega^\cdot$  maps to  $c_1$ . This hypothesis is required for the upper-bound direction of the minimality argument ( $\varepsilon_0$  is the first snap point). The canonical witness in epsilon\_zero\_snap\_canonical (ZP-L §VII) satisfies hfp directly by case analysis, but hfp is not derived from the structural axioms.

ZP-M §II closes this gap. Given monotonicity and  $\phi \varepsilon_0 = c_1$  as a minimal alignment hypothesis, hfp follows. The argument: for any fixed point  $\alpha$  of  $\omega^\cdot$ , epsilonZero\_le\_fixedPoint gives  $\varepsilon_0 \leq \alpha$ ; monotonicity then chains  $\phi \varepsilon_0 \leq \phi \alpha$ ; substituting  $c_1$  and using  $c_1$ 's absorbing property gives  $\phi \alpha = c_1$ .

### Theorem: hfp\_from\_epsilon\_zero (Incompleteness.lean §II)

For any  $\phi : \text{Ordinal} \rightarrow \text{MachinePhase}$  satisfying:

hmono:  $\forall \alpha \leq \beta, \text{join} (\phi \alpha) (\phi \beta) = \phi \beta$

h $\varepsilon_0$ :  $\phi \text{epsilonZero} = c_1$

we have:  $\forall \alpha, \omega^\alpha = \alpha \rightarrow \phi \alpha = c_1$ .

Proof: epsilonZero\_le\_fixedPoint gives  $\varepsilon_0 \leq \alpha$ ; hmono gives  $\text{join } c_1 (\phi \alpha) = \phi \alpha$ ;  $\text{join } c_1 x = c_1$  for all  $x$  (absorbing property of  $c_1$ ), so  $c_1 = \phi \alpha$ .

Lean purity: [propext, Classical.choice, Quot.sound]. ✓

### Theorem: snap\_unconditional (Incompleteness.lean §II)

For any  $\phi$  satisfying hmono, h0 (tower stages  $\mapsto c_0$ ), and h $\varepsilon_0$  ( $\phi \varepsilon_0 = c_1$ ):

$\phi \varepsilon_0 = c_1 \wedge \forall \alpha, \phi \alpha = c_1 \rightarrow \varepsilon_0 \leq \alpha$ .

### Theorem: snap\_unconditional (Incompleteness.lean §II)

$\varepsilon_0$  is the minimal snap threshold under minimal hypotheses.

Proof: snap\_exactly\_at\_epsilon\_zero with hfp supplied by hfp\_from\_epsilon\_zero.

Lean purity: [propext, Classical.choice, Quot.sound]. ✓

What §II achieves: hfp is no longer a free hypothesis in the minimality theorem. Given  $\phi_{\varepsilon_0} = c_1$  (the alignment condition: the map snaps at  $\varepsilon_0$ ) plus monotonicity, the full minimality result follows from the ordinal structure alone. hfp is a derived consequence, not an additional commitment.

## Section III: The Kleene-Ordinal Triangle

ZP-K established:  $c_0 = \perp$  is a Quine atom (da1\_closed\_concrete : IsQuineAtom ( $\perp$  : MachinePhase)). ZP-L established: the canonical snap map assigns  $c_1$  exactly at  $\varepsilon_0$ , with tower encodings in  $\mathbb{Z}_2$  converging to 0. The triangle connects all three objects formally:

| Edge                                       | Objects connected                             | Formal content                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $A \leftrightarrow C$ (ordinal snap)       | $\varepsilon_0 \leftrightarrow c_1$           | Canonical snap map: stages below $\varepsilon_0 \mapsto c_0$ ; $\varepsilon_0 \mapsto c_1$ (ZP-L §VII) |
| $A \leftrightarrow B$ (2-adic convergence) | $\text{Tower} \rightarrow 0 \in \mathbb{Z}_2$ | $\text{cnfToZp2}(\text{towerNONote } n) \rightarrow 0 \text{ in } \mathbb{Z}_2$ (ZP-L §IV)             |
| $B \leftrightarrow C$ (type bridge)        | $c_1 \leftrightarrow 0 \in \mathbb{Z}_2$      | $\text{snapEmbed } c_1 = 0$ (§I above)                                                                 |

### Theorem: snap\_state\_zp2\_is\_zero (Incompleteness.lean §III)

$\text{snapEmbed } ((\lambda \alpha : \text{Ordinal}, \text{if } \alpha < \varepsilon_0 \text{ then } c_0 \text{ else } c_1) \varepsilon_0) = 0$

The canonical snap map assigns  $c_1$  at  $\varepsilon_0$ ; snapEmbed sends  $c_1$  to 0.

The snap state at the ordinal threshold maps to the 2-adic zero.

Proof: simp (the if-condition evaluates to False at  $\alpha = \varepsilon_0$ ).

Lean purity: [propext, Classical.choice, Quot.sound]. ✓

### Theorem: zpm\_triangle (Incompleteness.lean §III)

All three edges of the triangle, co-proved:

$(A \leftrightarrow C) \forall n : \mathbb{N}, \text{fundamentalSeq } n < \varepsilon_0$

$(A \leftrightarrow C) (\lambda \alpha, \text{if } \alpha < \varepsilon_0 \text{ then } c_0 \text{ else } c_1) \varepsilon_0 = c_1$

$(A \leftrightarrow B) \text{Filter.Tendsto } (\lambda n, \text{cnfToZp2 } (\text{towerNONote } n)) \text{Filter.atTop } (\text{nhds } 0)$

**Theorem: zpm\_triangle (Incompleteness.lean §III)**

$(B \leftrightarrow C) \text{ snapEmbed } (\lambda \alpha, \text{if } \alpha < \varepsilon_0 \text{ then } c_0 \text{ else } c_1) \varepsilon_0 = 0$

Proof:  $\langle \text{epsilonZero\_tower\_lt, if\_neg (lt\_irrefl } \varepsilon_0), \text{tower\_converges\_to\_zero, snap\_state\_zp2\_is\_zero} \rangle$ .

Lean purity: [propext, Classical.choice, Quot.sound]. ✓

**Section IV: Shared Diagonalization Pattern**

Both the Kleene recursion theorem (ZP-K) and the ordinal fixed-point  $\varepsilon_0$  (ZP-L) arise from the same structural schema: a self-referential operation has a forced fixed point. In computability theory, the diagonal applies to codes and their Gödel numbers. In ordinal theory, the diagonal applies to the tower iteration  $\alpha \mapsto \omega^\alpha$ . The two domains share no mathematical machinery, but the diagonalization pattern is identical.

| Domain                | Self-referential operation                                                        | Forced fixed point                                                       |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Computability (ZP-K)  | $\text{eval } c = \text{selfApply } c$ ( $c$ runs on its own Gödel number)        | $\exists c : \text{Code}, \text{IsComputationalQuine } c$                |
| Ordinal theory (ZP-L) | $\omega^\alpha = \alpha$ ( $\alpha$ is a fixed point of $\omega$ -exponentiation) | $\varepsilon_0 = \text{nfp } (\omega^\cdot) 0$ , the least such $\alpha$ |

**Theorem: both\_fixed\_points\_exist (Incompleteness.lean §IV)**

$(\exists c : \text{Code}, \forall n, \text{eval } c \ n = \text{eval } c \ (\text{encode } c + n)) \wedge$

$(\exists \alpha : \text{Ordinal}, \omega^\alpha = \alpha \wedge \forall \beta, \omega^\beta = \beta \rightarrow \alpha \leq \beta)$

Both diagonalization patterns produce fixed points, co-proved in one formal context.

Left: Kleene quine (period = Gödel number of  $c$ ), via `computational_quine_exists`.

Right:  $\varepsilon_0 = \omega^{\varepsilon_0}$ , minimal; via `epsilonZero_fixedPoint` and `epsilonZero_le_fixedPoint`.

The co-existence is the formal content: two forced fixed points, two domains, one theorem.

Lean purity: [propext, Classical.choice, Quot.sound]. ✓

**Remark R-M.1: DA-1 Path 2 and the Limits of the Diagonalization Frame**

`both_fixed_points_exist` establishes that Kleene diagonalization (a code on its own Gödel number) and ordinal diagonalization ( $\varepsilon_0 = \omega^{\varepsilon_0}$ , least fixed point) are the same structural pattern in two domains. Both are textbook instances of the diagonalization schema.

L-INF (ZP-C §II:  $\perp$  has divergent surprisal — unbounded information content, incompressible by any finite description) is structurally analogous. Whether it fits the same diagonalization schema formally is the open question.

**Remark R-M.1: DA-1 Path 2 and the Limits of the Diagonalization Frame**

The formally unconnected instance is L-INF. This gap is DA-1 Path 2 — the informational bridge. The reason Path 2 resisted formalization is now visible from this layer: L-INF is a measure-theoretic statement (Shannon entropy, probability distributions) while the Kleene quine is a computability-theoretic statement (partial recursive functions, Gödel encoding). The two frameworks share no mathematical machinery.

The diagonalization frame established here provides the common conceptual ground, but the formal bridge requires the Kolmogorov complexity connection: incompressibility is the concept that lives in both worlds simultaneously. That bridge is outside the current Lean scope, pending AIT infrastructure not yet in Mathlib.

DA-1 Path 2 was recharacterized in ZP-E/ZP-K as a foundational commitment rather than a missing proof. The diagonalization frame here makes the boundary precise: the gap is not a skipped proof step but a genuine framework separation — measure-theoretic surprisal on one side, computability-theoretic encoding on the other, with no shared machinery in current Mathlib.

**Theorem Summary**

| Theorem                 | Section | Status   |
|-------------------------|---------|----------|
| snapEmbed_injective     | §I      | Proved ✓ |
| snapEmbed_mul_morphism  | §I      | Proved ✓ |
| snapEmbed_c0_val        | §I      | Proved ✓ |
| snapEmbed_c1_dvd        | §I      | Proved ✓ |
| hfp_from_epsilon_zero   | §II     | Proved ✓ |
| snap_unconditional      | §II     | Proved ✓ |
| snap_state_zp2_is_zero  | §III    | Proved ✓ |
| zpm_triangle            | §III    | Proved ✓ |
| both_fixed_points_exist | §IV     | Proved ✓ |

**Axiom Purity**

All theorems carry axiom footprint: [propext, Classical.choice, Quot.sound].

These are standard Mathlib infrastructure axioms, inherited from ordinal theory (ZP-L), 2-adic analysis (ZP-B), and computability theory (ZP-K).

Classical.choice is load-bearing in the ordinal fixed-point (nfp) and present in the computability fixed-point (Kleene's theorem). In the computability layer Classical.choice is reached through Mathlib's numbering of program codes (Denumerable Code): it is present even in a computable instance with a constant code. ZP-K's machinePhaseKleene also picks botCode with Classical.choose, which is what makes that instance noncomputable. Whether the numbering's footprint is essential is not measured. ZP-K Section IV tabulates the measured footprints.

## Axiom Purity

Zero sorry in Incompleteness.lean. Verified: lake build, May 2026.

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End of ZP-M | Kleene–Ordinal Bridge | snapEmbed type bridge | hfp gap closed | zpm\_triangle co-proved |  
both\_fixed\_points\_exist | R-M.1: DA-1 Path 2 boundary | All Incompleteness.lean theorems verified. Axioms: [propext,  
Classical.choice, Quot.sound].